UX RESEARCH · CHECKOUT GUIDANCE

Card Saving UX Best Practices

The rule: Don't preselect card-saving consent

> Baymard's standards, built on 200k+ hours of UX research, don't carry a guideline phrased exactly as "never precheck save my card" — but the pattern is clear from adjacent checkout research: **optional, relationship-extending choices should not be assumed on the user's behalf.**

WHAT TO DO INSTEAD

- ✓ Use a standard checkbox
- ✓ Leave it **unchecked** by default
- ✓ Label it plainly — e.g. *"Save this card for next time"*
- ✓ Only show it when it's actually relevant to the user's context

Want a default in the payment step? Default the method, not the consent.

Baymard supports preselecting the *most common payment method* to reduce friction. That is very different from pre-consenting a saved credential — one speeds the task, the other decides for the user.

WHAT THE INDUSTRY SAYS

RETAIL PRACTICE

Most major retailers do **not** pre-select a "Save this card" box. Stripe includes this guideline directly in its documentation.

STRIPE

"Collect explicit consent from the customer for this specific use. For example, include a 'Save my payment method for future' checkbox."

docs.stripe.com/payments/save-during-payment

VISA

Visa's rules say a merchant may use a stored credential **only as agreed with the cardholder.**

paymentusa.com/blog/card-on-file

Compliance note: global laws such as GDPR may explicitly prohibit pre-ticked checkboxes. Pre-checked consent is a recognized dark pattern. · termsfeed.com/blog/dark-patterns

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November 2026